



ICT PROFICIENCY CERTIFICATION EXAMINATION FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Q. What is the ICT Proficiency Certification Examination?

- A. The ICT Specialist Proficiency Examination is designed to evaluate the competence of an individual to perform programming or systems analysis and design functions. This is pursuant to PD 1408, which directs the National Computer Center (NCC), now the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT), and the Civil Service Commission (CSC) to devise ways of determining the fitness of individuals in occupying highly technical ICT positions and through which the awarding of appropriate ICT (EDP) Specialist Eligibility will be based.

Q. What Civil Service Eligibility will be granted to successful examinees?

- A. The EDP Specialist Eligibility (EDPSE) shall be conferred to passers of the proficiency certification exam, or passers of the training courses conducted by the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT), through the ICT Literacy and Competency Development Bureau (ILCDB) (*granted pursuant to CSC Resolution No. 90-083 dated January 22, 1990*). The EDPSE shall refer to a person who has at least a bachelor's degree or its equivalent and has been issued a certificate of proficiency in any of the following areas;

- A. Electronic Data Processing System and Analysis and Design
- B. Computer Programming
- C. Computer Operation

Q. What positions can the earned eligibility be applied to?

- A. The EDPSE shall be considered appropriate only to functionally related positions belonging to the Information Technology/Management Information System Group, and to other positions as may be determined by the CSC. (*Provided under Item No. 8, Part V of CSC MC No. 12, s. 2003 re: Revised Policies on Qualification Standards*).

Q. What are the benefits of the proficiency certification examination?

- A. Aside from the grant of CSC eligibility, employers, prospective programmers, and systems analysts, as well as ICT schools/training institutions, the examination can be used:
- as a substitute / equivalent to a CSC Professional eligibility;
 - by supervisors to evaluate the competence of current or would-be programmers and systems analysts;

- by an individual to assess his/her knowledge and skills for the purpose of continually improving his/her own technical abilities; and
- by ICT training centers to enrich their curricula to enable their students to have a better chance of joining the corps of competent ICT professionals.

Q. What is the proficiency certification process?

A. The certification process of **Assess-Build-Certify-Develop** will be implemented as follows:

Assess. All prospective examinees will be assessed by an authorized DICT representative for free. The tool, which the Competency, Certification and Courseware Development Division (C3D2) will design, will be a written Diagnostic Examination that will assess the examinees' knowledge in Programming. The score attained from this assessment, forms 20% of the total score of the examinee should he/she passes the assessment and takes the Hands-On Certification examination. Passing score for the Assessment is 20.

Build. Those who will not pass the assessment may have to undergo additional hours of training and/or learning activities that will enhance the examinees' knowledge and skills in Programming.

Certify. Those who pass the Assessment will be eligible to take the ICT Proficiency Certification Examination, which will be administered by an authorized C3D2 staff. This hands-on examination is a six (6) hour simple application development using the examinee's preferred programming language. CSC-accredited programming languages are Java, Visual Basic v6.0, Visual Basic.Net, C Language, C++, and C#. Passing score for this exam is 80:

Type of Exam	Percent (%)
From Diagnostic exam	20
From Hands-On	80
Total	100

Develop. To further enhance the competency through additional training or certification.

An examinee who gets an accumulated total rating of 80% or higher is considered ICT Proficient.

Q. Who can take the proficiency certification examination?

A. An applicant must be:

1. a Filipino citizen; and
2. with a bachelor's degree in:
 - a. IT or a related field; or
 - b. Engineering or any Non-IT field provided that he/she:
 - has attended at least forty (40) hours of programming or ICT-related training; or
 - currently employed or performing programming / ICT-related functions as certified by the HR department
3. graduating students of ICT or related field as certified by the University / College Dean or Registrar

Q. What is the coverage of the proficiency certification examination?

A. The coverage of the Diagnostic examination and the Hands-on examination are as follows:

- Diagnostic Exam (Written)
 1. Program simulation
 2. Number System
 3. Data Structures
 4. System Development Life Cycle
 5. Object-Oriented Programming Concepts
 6. Networking Concepts
 7. File Access Methods
 8. Database concepts
 9. New and current ICT Trends
- Certification Exam (Hands-On)
 1. Data Manipulation (String, Searching, Validation, Array Handling, Array List Handling, etc)
 2. Object Oriented Programming (abstraction, encapsulation, polymorphism, inheritance, association, aggregation, and composition)
 3. File Handling (Input/Output Validation, CRUD - Create, Read, Update, Delete)
 4. Database Manipulation (CRUD - Create, Read, Update, Delete)
 5. Data Structure and Algorithms
 6. Control Structures (Conditional Statements, Iteration Statements)
 7. Number System (Binary, Octal, Decimal, Hexadecimal)

Q. What languages can be used in the hands-on examination?

A. Examinees may use any of the following programming languages:

1. C Language
2. C#

3. C++
4. Java
5. Visual Basic 6.0
6. Visual Basic.Net

Q. What is the application process?

- A. An individual interested in taking the Diagnostic Exam should accomplish the DICT application form and submit it to the Regional Focal Person or to the Registrar at the DICT Central Office, and present valid ID and photocopy of PSA Birth Certificate for verification purposes.

Only those who passed the Diagnostic Examination will be eligible to take the Certification Examination. The following documents must be submitted before the examination date:

- Diagnostic Examination Notification Slip;
- Duly Accomplished Form 2 (ILCDB Form – 2);
- Two (2) passport-sized pictures with white background and signature over the printed name. The format of the name tag as follows:
Last Name, First Name, Middle Initial and Extension Name (if any)
(e.g. DELA CRUZ, JUAN JR. C.);
- Photocopy of PSA Birth Certificate;
- Transcript of Records;
- Diploma;
- For graduating students of any IT-related bachelor's degree courses, submit the Certificate of Candidacy for Graduation signed by the Dean;
- For IT-related bachelor's degree holders, submit Certified True Copy (CTC) of Transcript of Records duly authenticated by the Registrar Office;
- For Non-IT related bachelor's degree holder, must have acquired 40-hour IT training or a practicing Programmer as certified by the HR of the company.

Q. When and where will the diagnostic examination and proficiency certification examination be conducted?

- A. The conduct of the Diagnostic and Certification Examinations may be arranged with the DICT through the Regional Focal Persons or the Registrar of the ICT Literacy and Competency Development Bureau (ILCDB). Both examinations are conducted at the DICT or the school computer laboratory for school implementation.

A minimum of 15 examinees and a maximum of 20 are required for Diagnostic while for Hands-On, a minimum of 10 and a maximum of 20 examinees, per examination conduct.

Walk-ins are **NO longer allowed** for both examinations. Examinations with more than the maximum number of examinees are subject to approval.

Q. How much is the examination fee?

- A. Only successful passers of the Diagnostic Exam will proceed to the Certification exam and pay an examination fee of
1. Five Hundred Pesos (P500.00) for Professionals
 2. Three Hundred Pesos (P300.00) for Graduating Students

The paid amount will be automatically forfeited once the examinee fails to take the exam on the scheduled date. The “NO EXAMINATION, NO REFUND” policy will be strictly implemented.

The DICT utilizes the five plus one (5+1) scheme which enables the universities/colleges to have one (1) faculty member to take the examination for free for every five (5) paying students registered. The free slots however must be used on the same date of the examination schedule.

Examinees should pay the examination fee five (5) working days prior to the examination schedule. Failure to do so will result in non-inclusion to the signed List of Examinees released by the ILCDB Registrar.

Q. When will the result of the diagnostic examination and Proficiency Certification examination be released?

- A. The examination results and individual Notification Letters for the Diagnostic Examinations are released within 25 working days upon receipt of the answer sheets and other pertinent documents, while for Certification Examinations, results are released 40 working days after the date of the examination. For both examinations with more than the maximum number of examinees, the schedule of the release of results may vary.

The Diagnostic results for the NCR are released through the ILCDB Registrar while for the other regions, results are released through the Regional ILCDB Focal Persons.

For the Certification Examination results, the ILCDB Registrar will transmit the pertinent documents to the implementing DICT Regional Office, through the DICT Central Receiving and Releasing (CRRU) ten (10) working days after receipt of the CRRU.

Q. Is retake allowed for both examinations?

- A. For both examinations, there is no limit to the number of retakes.

For Diagnostic Examination, an examinee can only retake the exams upon confirmation of results. However, should a registered/confirmed examinee fail to take the scheduled examination or “No Show,” he/she will be waitlisted for the next scheduled examination.

For the Hands-On Examination, an examinee can only retake the examination at least six (6) months after the previous examination conducted.

Q. What Certificate/s will be issued to the passers?

A. Passers of the Certification Examination will be issued a Certificate of Proficiency by the DICT, which will be the basis of the CSC in conferring the EDP/ICT Specialist Eligibility. The said Certificate must be submitted to the CSC Office of the Region where the passers took the examination for conferment of eligibility within three (3) years of the issuance date.

For inquiries, please contact:

ILCDB Registrar

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